

CLIMATE CHANGE AND HEALTH SECTOR PLANNING: A MIXED-METHODS ANALYSIS OF NATIONAL HEALTH STRATEGIES OF 101 COUNTRIES.



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Introduction

Climate change is the greatest risk to human health in the 21st century. National health strategies and plans (NHSPs) are crucial in shaping a country’s future health system, yet it is unclear how they address climate change-related health risks. This study aimed to (1) analyze the content of NHSPs regarding climate change, and (2) identify factors that may explain the inclusion of climate change in NHSPs.

Results

Climate change was addressed in 73 NHSPs, but only 38 proposed adaptation strategies. African and low-income countries tend to address climate change in their NHSPs more frequently than high-income countries. Regression results showed that countries with greater adaptive capacity (lower vulnerability) generally show greater climate change consideration. There was no association between climate risk and climate change consideration.

Methodology

NHSPs for 101 countries were obtained from the WHO country planning repository. We analysed NHSPs using keyword searches to identify references to climate change and health risks. NHSPs were categorized into red (no consideration of climate change), yellow (discussion of climate change), and green (yellow + discussion of adaptation strategies). Two logistic regression models were run to analyze the relationship between NHSP categorization and national income (GDP per capita, climate risk (CRI), and climate change-related health risk (ND-GAIN).

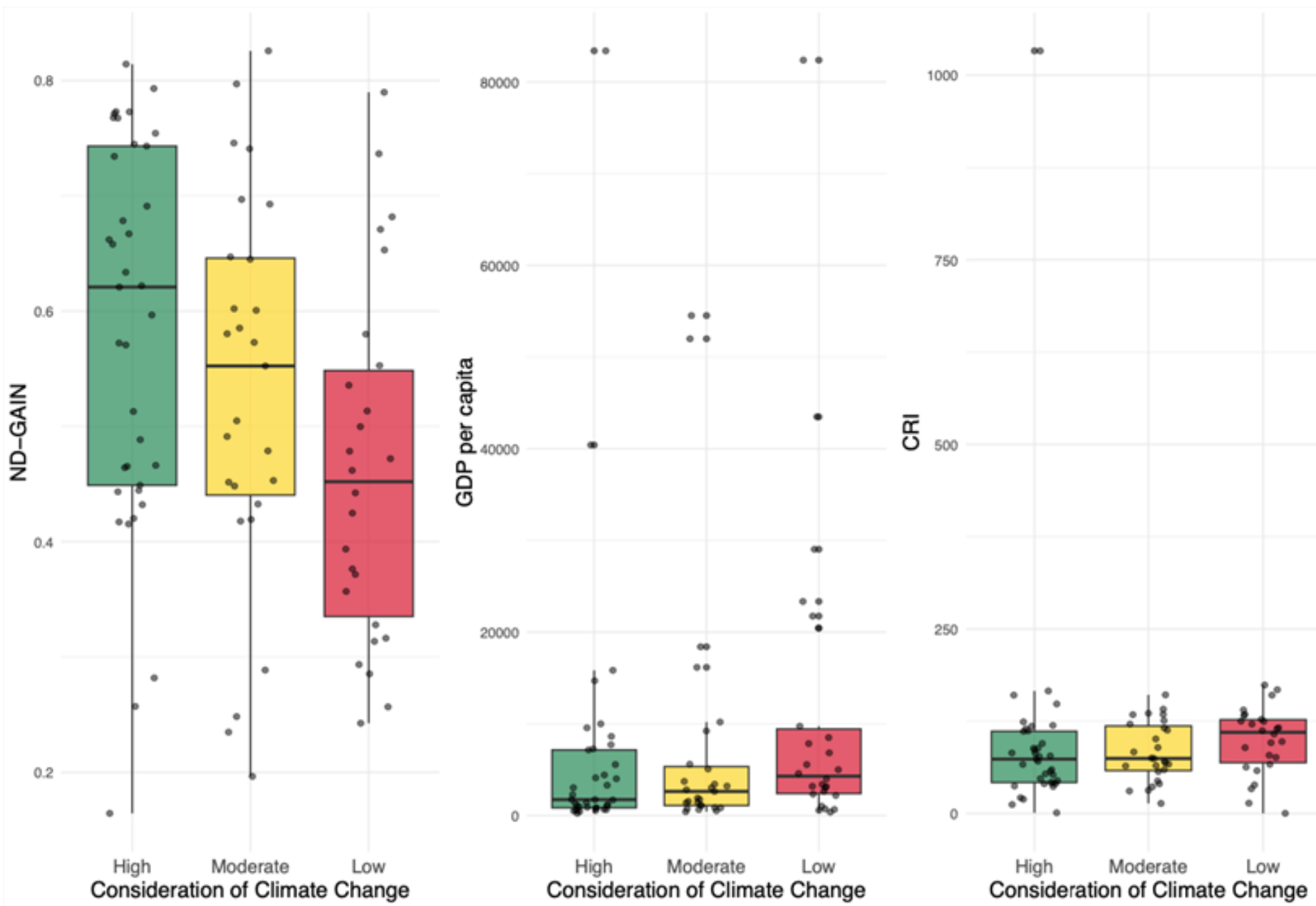


Figure 1:
Boxplot of Distribution of Predictors Across Levels of Climate Change Consideration in NHSPs.

Conclusion

Climate adaptation measures are included only in about one third of NHSPs. Countries should include climate change and adaptation measures more systematically in their NHSPs to provide strategic direction for the necessary transformation of their health systems in view of climate change.

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